An Observed Failure in a Long-Running ChatGPT Analytical Conversation

A chronological and analytical account

Introduction

This report documents an extended conversation in which ChatGPT was asked to conduct blind Jupiter-sign assessments of writers using a detailed analytical methodology supplied by the user.

The task required ChatGPT to reconstruct an author's way of perceiving the world, identify the problems arising from that perception, examine how the author produces meaning, and distinguish this from the deeper source of intuitive legitimacy represented by Jupiter.

The methodology also required all twelve signs to be assessed symmetrically before selecting primary and secondary candidates. After an incorrect prediction, both candidates were to be excluded and the remaining signs independently reassessed.

The conversation initially produced four consecutive correct first-guess predictions. However, performance subsequently deteriorated during the assessments of Douglas Kennedy, Colette and Jack Thorne. The exchange eventually ended with an "Unknown error".

The analytical assessments and interpretations discussed below were primarily generated by ChatGPT. The user supplied the governing methodology, selected the authors, provided feedback, identified methodological errors and directed subsequent reassessments.

The change after four successful predictions

The first four correct predictions demonstrated that the experimental approach could produce promising results. However, the subsequent assessments did not maintain the same level of performance.

The deterioration was not simply a matter of making incorrect predictions. ChatGPT increasingly struggled to apply the methodology consistently, maintain the distinction between perception and intuitive legitimacy, and preserve the procedural constraints established by the user.

Douglas Kennedy became the first extended example of this deterioration.

Douglas Kennedy: premature conclusions and repeated methodological failures

The Douglas Kennedy assessment exposed several problems.

Premature conclusions

Although ChatGPT had been instructed to assess all twelve signs before selecting candidates, its first assessment favoured Sagittarius and Capricorn before completing a genuinely symmetrical comparison.

It subsequently produced several reassessments, repeatedly changing its interpretation of Kennedy's literary activity.

The sequence was:

• Sagittarius / Capricorn — rejected.

• Gemini / Libra — rejected.

• Taurus / Pisces — rejected.

• Scorpio / Virgo — rejected.

• Leo / Cancer — Cancer was correct.

The fifth attempt finally included the correct sign as its secondary candidate. However, this did not erase the methodological problems in the preceding assessments.

Difficulty maintaining conversational state

The user had established that the shorthand response "i." rejected both candidates in the preceding prediction.

ChatGPT repeatedly restated its interpretation of this convention, even though it had already been established. The problem was not necessarily that it failed to exclude the candidates, but that it did not maintain the

conversational state naturally and consistently.

It had to keep track of previous predictions, rejected signs, methodological corrections and the next required stage. This became an increasingly visible weakness.

Failure to implement the perception model

The methodology required reconstructing the specific perceptual operation through which an author encounters reality and selects particular problems.

ChatGPT often described Kennedy's subject matter—relationships, family history, economic circumstances and personal contradictions—without adequately identifying the deeper perceptual mechanism connecting these observations to his production of meaning.

When corrected, it acknowledged the distinction and promised to make perception analysis mandatory. Nevertheless, subsequent assessments still struggled to implement it consistently.

Contamination from obsolete methodology

ChatGPT also introduced visibility scores and natural-fit tests that did not belong to the governing version of the methodology.

It acknowledged that these elements had been imported from older versions of the framework. This demonstrated another problem: it could retain obsolete procedures and combine them with the current instructions.

The Kennedy sequence therefore showed a recurring gap between understanding a correction and consistently applying it.

Colette: procedural instability and failure to enforce constraints

The Colette assessment continued the pattern.

ChatGPT initially conducted a broad assessment of all twelve signs, but subsequent rounds produced repeated changes in its sign-free interpretation and candidate selection.

It moved through several reassessments, successively excluding candidate pairs. The analysis shifted between different explanations of Colette's literary activity, including:

• The intrinsic reality of sensory and bodily experience.

• The continuity of formative experience and relationships.

• The disclosure of private experience beneath conventional appearances.

• The conditions and constraints shaping individual lives.

These were not necessarily irrelevant interpretations. The problem was that ChatGPT repeatedly reconstructed its understanding without reliably establishing which account best explained the entire literary activity.

There was also a significant procedural contradiction.

The methodology contained a stopping rule intended to prevent endless sequential guessing after six rejected signs. ChatGPT explicitly recognised this rule and announced that it should stop.

However, when the user instructed it to continue, ChatGPT proceeded with further reassessments and predictions.

Its final recorded Colette prediction was Capricorn primary and Leo secondary. The supplied transcript moves on to Jack Thorne without recording a judgement of that prediction.

The Colette sequence illustrates how ChatGPT could recognise a methodological constraint, explain why it mattered, and then fail to enforce it consistently.

Jack Thorne: evidential restriction and final assessment

The Jack Thorne assessment provides another example of methodological inconsistency.

ChatGPT selected Pisces as its primary candidate and Capricorn as its secondary candidate.

In the analysis, it treated Thorne's own stated purpose of doing "empathy work" as substantial evidence for Pisces.

This conflicted with the source-independence requirement in the methodology: the author's own explanations of their work were not to be used as evidence for assigning the Jupiter sign.

The analysis also gave considerable attention to empathy, social conditions, disability, class and institutional structures. These were relevant subjects, but the central question was whether ChatGPT had successfully distinguished the author's subject matter and methods from the deeper source of intuitive legitimacy.

The final recorded user feedback was most likely "i." (but it wasn't stored in the transcript), which, according to the established convention, rejected both proposed candidates.

Immediately afterwards, the conversation displayed:

Unknown error

The Jack Thorne prediction therefore should not be counted as a success. Both proposed candidates had been rejected before the conversation became unusable.

The final technical failure

The conversation ended with an "Unknown error" during the Jack Thorne assessment sequence.

It was no longer possible to continue the discussion in that conversation.

This establishes that the interaction became unusable, but it does not establish the technical cause. The surviving transcript does not provide diagnostic information sufficient to attribute the failure to context exhaustion, a backend problem, a client-side problem or another specific mechanism.

The technical interruption must be distinguished from the analytical and conversational failures documented earlier. They occurred within the same extended interaction, but the available evidence does not prove that the analytical deterioration caused the technical failure.

Three overlapping levels of failure

The conversation reveals three distinct but interacting problems.

First: analytical failure.

ChatGPT repeatedly formed conclusions prematurely, struggled to reconstruct perceptual mechanisms, confused subject matter and methods with intuitive legitimacy, and imported obsolete analytical procedures.

Second: conversational-state and procedural failure.

It did not consistently maintain established conventions, previous predictions, rejected candidates and methodological constraints. It could explain the correct procedure but did not reliably execute it. The Colette stopping-rule episode is a particularly clear example.

Third: technical failure.

The conversation eventually terminated with an "Unknown error" during the Jack Thorne assessment. The precise cause remains unknown.

Overall interpretation

The most interesting feature of this conversation is the discrepancy between ChatGPT's ability to describe a methodology and its ability to sustain that methodology in practice.

It could acknowledge mistakes, explain why they were mistakes, formulate corrections and promise improved execution. Yet similar problems continued to appear in subsequent assessments.

The four initial correct predictions demonstrated promising analytical potential. The subsequent Douglas Kennedy and Colette sequences, however, exposed weaknesses in consistency, state maintenance and procedural discipline. The Jack Thorne assessment showed that evidential restrictions could still be violated, even after repeated corrections.

The final technical failure added a separate operational problem: the conversation could no longer sustain the experiment.

This is therefore not simply a record of incorrect astrological guesses. It documents a progressive deterioration in the reliability of a complex analytical process, despite repeated user corrections and ChatGPT's apparent understanding of those corrections.

The detailed Douglas Kennedy exchange provides a particularly useful example of how these failures developed across successive reassessments.